agreement and then proceed to the other sectors. They must settle all three sectors in one comprehensive agreement.

From 2003 to 2019, the Special Representatives met twenty-two times. After the early breakthrough in the 2005 agreement, stalemate and discord once again set in. Conflict, as in the past, began to replace cooperation. In 2006, as we will see shortly, China suddenly laid claim to all of Arunachal Pradesh. It also indicated its unhappiness over Clause VI of the 2005 accord which had suggested that any agreement would 'safeguard due interests of their settled populations in the border areas' – India took this to mean that only minor adjustments in the eastern sector would be necessary. By 2008, India was recording growing Chinese incursions. Outright military confrontations occurred in 2013, 2014, 2015, and 2017.

After the 2014 confrontation, India changed tack on the border, in two respects. Since 1988, it had gone along with the view that normalization would lead to military stability and eventually a border settlement. Delhi now reversed the causal logic. A border settlement and military stability were essential for further normalization. Up to 2005, India and China had also seemingly agreed that a border settlement was central to their negotiations. Delhi replaced this with the contention that the delineation of the LAC was more urgent than a final border settlement. At a press conference with Xi, during his official visit to India in 2014, even as Indian and Chinese troops were eyeball to eyeball in Chumar in Ladakh, Prime Minister Narendra Modi gestured at both changes in the Indian approach: 'peace and stability in our relations and along our borders are essential for us to realize the enormous potential in our relations [i.e. normalization] . . . [and] clarification of Line of Actual Control would greatly contribute to our efforts to maintain peace and tranquility'.[101]

When Beijing failed to respond positively, Modi repeated his suggestion on the LAC at a press conference in China the following year.[102] During the same visit in a speech at Tsinghua University he summarized India's emerging position:

> In recent years, we have deepened our political engagement. We have kept our borders peaceful . . . Yet, if we have to realise the extraordinary potential of our partnership, we must also address